ZikShare

ACADEMIC VAULT

UNIZIK FRESHER EDITION | 2026

Clubs, Leadership and Volunteering: Build Skills Without Losing Your Semester

Choose activities that develop you and still leave room for your degree

CAMPUS LIFE

Campus Life

General Studies (GST / CED)
GST Directorate | 100L

Written for students, by students.

Practical notes, worked examples, practice questions and a revision plan.

Study smarter. Ask better questions. Pass with understanding.

Independent study support | Not an official UNIZIK publication

START HERE

Why this pack exists

Extracurricular activity can build real skills or quietly consume your study time. This pack helps you choose a small number of commitments deliberately, contribute well, and record what you learn in a way that later helps with internships and job applications.

This is a student-written study companion, not a reproduced lecture handout or a leaked examination paper. Use it to organise the topics you are taught, practise the kind of thinking your course rewards, and walk into class with better questions.

What you will be able to do

- Choose activities aligned with your goals and available time.
- Contribute effectively in a team and handle responsibility reliably.
- Balance leadership roles with academic workload.
- Record achievements and skills for future applications.

How to use this pack

1. Skim the whole pack once in 20 minutes so you know what is inside.
2. Work through one section at a time with your lecture note and recommended text beside you.
3. Attempt the practice questions before reading the answers. Mark what you missed.
4. Use the final checklist to plan your revision week, one tick per study session.

> **Confirm your official course outline**
> Course codes, credit units and outlines can differ by department and session. Treat this pack as supplementary support and confirm the current outline with your lecturer, course rep or departmental handbook before an assessment.

Choose deliberately

Depth in two activities beats shallow membership in eight.

- Decide what you want to develop: communication, organisation, technical skill or a network.
- Attend a meeting before committing to a role.
- Ask current members how much time the role actually takes.
- Check that meetings do not clash with core lectures or labs.
- Prefer organisations with clear structures and real projects.
- Leave gracefully if an activity is consuming your study time.

Work well in a team

Reliability is the most valued trait in student teams.

- Confirm what you own and when it is due.
- Communicate early when a deadline is at risk.
- Write brief minutes with decisions and owners.
- Do the unglamorous tasks sometimes; it builds trust.
- Give credit publicly and correct privately.
- Document events with photos and simple reports for continuity.

> **Leadership is not a title**
> A treasurer who keeps clean records and a volunteer who shows up consistently are doing more leadership than a titleholder who disappears.

Record what you learn

Experience that cannot be described is hard to use later.

- Keep a simple log: role, dates, tasks, results and skills used.
- Quantify where possible: number of participants, funds raised, sessions organised.
- Collect one or two references from supervisors.
- Save certificates and photographs in a folder.
- Reflect on one failure each semester and what you changed.
- Turn the log into CV bullet points while details are fresh.

PRACTICE, NOT PREDICTION

Check your understanding

These questions are written for this pack to test the ideas above. They are not past examination questions and do not predict what your lecturer will set. Answer first, then compare.

1. How many activities should a first-year student join?

Answer: A small number - often one or two meaningful commitments - so that participation is real and study time is protected.

2. Why write minutes with owners?

Answer: They turn discussion into accountable action and prevent tasks from being forgotten or duplicated.

3. What should a contribution log contain?

Answer: Role, dates, tasks, measurable results, skills used and contacts for references.

4. How do you leave a role responsibly?

Answer: Give notice, hand over documentation and contacts, and complete outstanding commitments.

5. Why quantify achievements?

Answer: Numbers make contributions concrete and credible in CVs and interviews.

Your 7-step action plan

Tick each step only when you have done it. A tick you cannot defend is worse than an empty box.

- [ ] Write the three skills you most want to develop.
- [ ] Attend one meeting before joining.
- [ ] Choose no more than two commitments for the semester.
- [ ] Create a contribution log with dates and results.
- [ ] Take on one specific responsibility and deliver it.
- [ ] Collect contact details for a reference.
- [ ] Review your commitments at mid-semester and adjust.

Keep going

One pack will not carry a semester. Pair this with your lecture notes, tutorials, and the past questions your department actually releases. If a topic still feels unclear, take a specific question to your lecturer or course rep - "I do not understand the difference between X and Y" gets a better answer than "I do not understand this course".

> **More from the ZikShare Academic Vault**
> Find faculty primers, study-skills guides, money and career packs, and digital-skills workbooks in the ZikShare Library. New packs are added every semester.

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YOUR WORKSPACE

Notes, questions and things to ask

Use this page in class or during revision. Write questions you could not answer instead of copying slides.

Three ideas I can now explain without notes:

A question I still cannot answer:

For my lecturer or course rep:

Next revision action and date:

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